

Q.3 What are the principles of writing good paragraph? Discuss in brief.
(Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Aug.-23, Marks 4

Q.4 What is the importance of coherence in a paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Jan.-24, Marks 3

Q.5 Explain 'topic sentence' with an example. (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Jan.-24, Marks 3

Q.6 What are some effective strategies for crafting engaging introductions and impactful conclusions in a paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : July-24, Marks 4



Unit 4

4

Speaking Skills

Syllabus

Introduction to Phonetics, IPA, Place of articulation, transcription, Presentation skills- an introduction, Analyzing audience and locale, Organizing a presentation, Introduction to group communication, Conversations, Debates, dialogues, and GDs, (Suggestive list of words for Phonetic Transcription is available in the link. provided.)

Contents

- 4.1 Introduction to Phonetics
- 4.2 International Phonetic Alphabet
- 4.3 Places of Articulation
- 4.4 Presentation Skills
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- 4.6 Communication Style in Conversations / Group Communication
- 4.7 University Questions with Answers

Learning objectives :

- To learn spoken English.
- To understand the correct pronunciation for speaking.
- To learn the effective way of communicating for presentations and different conversations in organizations.

4.1 Introduction to Phonetics

- Speaking is the first thing that a person learns for communicating rather than writing. Language was always used in spoken form first rather than in written form. Also, for any non-native speaker of a language, the first way to communicate is through speaking. For example, visitors to foreign lands must know how to speak the local language or a common language like English so that they can manage their daily activity with the least communication. It is important that every professional must know at least spoken English as businesses have now become global and English language is the widely used language in the world.
- Spoken words are collections of sounds. Knowing the language is not enough for speaking as it is important to use the correct sound of the word to communicate effectively. Moreover, the knowledge of sound is also required to comprehend the listening in a particular language. Phonetics is a branch of linguistics that studies how humans produce and perceive sounds or, in the case of sign languages, the equivalent aspects of sign. It deals with the sounds of speech and their production, combination, description and representation by written symbols. The alphabetic system of phonetic notation or the set of symbols denoting the sounds of letters and words is called the **International Phonetic Alphabet**.

4.2 International Phonetic Alphabet

- The International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) is an alphabetic system of phonetic notation based primarily on the Latin script. It was devised by the international phonetic association in the late 19th century as a standard written representation for the sounds of speech. This alphabetic system is required because the English language does not have enough letters to represent all the sounds.
- Unlike Hindi or Gujarati, the English language does not have enough letters to represent sounds and so their combination (words) do not tell us how to pronounce them. In other words, English is not a phonetic language. For example, Gujarati has alphabets (34 consonants and 14 vowels- matras) that represent all possible sounds made by human beings through mouth and so it does not require any phonetic because written words

themselves represent the sound. This is not the case with English and so the spelling of a word doesn't tell about the sound of that word.

- Moreover, English spelling is confusing for non-native speakers because it has been influenced by numerous other languages like German, Latin, French and the Scandinavian languages. Sometimes the same sound is produced with different combinations of letters and the other times, the same spelling may sound differently. For example, the same sound is found in the following letter combinations which are underlined : shoe, champagne, examination, expansion, sugar. Also, there are words that sound the same but with different spellings and meanings, they are called homophones. The list of **homophones** are given below :

Spelling	Meaning
Altar	Structure used for worship
Alter	To change
Allowed	Permitted
Aloud	Loudly
Bored	Not interested or excited
Board	Black or white plank for writing
Cereal	Any grain
Serial	In series or sequence
Die	Verb of death
Dye	Substance to give colour
Fair	Just, or fair in colour
Fare	Money paid against a service
Great	Very good or above average
Grate	Make shreds by peeling roughly
Heel	The part of foot
Heal	Recover
Idle	Without work
Idol	Image or object of worship
New	Fresh

Knew	Already in knowledge
Soar	Moving higher
Sore	Painful or injured
Lessen	To make less
Lesson	Learning
Male	A gender
Mail	Communication received as letter
Peek	Short or quick glance
Peak	Highest point of mountain
Road	A path
Rode	Past tense of ride

- From the above table we can see that though the spellings are different all the sets of words have the same pronunciation, but different meanings. This means that it is very difficult to guess the correct pronunciation of any word just from its spelling. This is the reason that a separate phonetic alphabet is required which guides the learner to pronounce each word correctly.

4.2.1 Phonetic Symbols

- There are a total of 44 phonetic symbols in IPA out of which 24 are consonant (voiced and voiceless consonants) sounds and 20 vowel sounds. In phonetics, a voiced consonant is a consonant which is pronounced with the vibration of the vocal cords. For example, the sound [z] is a voiced consonant, while [s] is not, and it is called a **voiceless consonant**. You can feel when your vocal cords are vibrating by putting your finger at your larynx.
- The list of consonant sounds along with a familiar example to identify the sound of the symbol is given below :

Consonant sound

VOICELESS	VOICED	
/p/ - <u>p</u> ut	/b/ - <u>b</u> at	/n/ - <u>n</u> et
/k/ - <u>k</u> ite	/g/ - <u>g</u> et	/ŋ/ - <u>ŋ</u> ing
/t/ - <u>t</u> ell	/d/ - <u>d</u> o	/l/ - <u>l</u> ive
/θ/ - <u>th</u> in	/ð/ - <u>th</u> ey	/r/ - <u>r</u> un

/s/ - <u>s</u> un	/z/ - <u>z</u> oo	/w/ - <u>w</u> in
/ʃ/ - <u>sh</u> oe	/ʒ/ - tele <u>visi</u> on	/j/ - <u>y</u> ou
/tʃ/ - <u>ch</u> eer	/dʒ/ - <u>j</u> oke	
/f/ - <u>f</u> an	/v/ - <u>v</u> ery	
/h/ - <u>h</u> ere	/m/ - <u>m</u> en	

- Vowel sounds are classified as **monophthongs** and **diphthongs**.
- A **monophthong** is a single, pure vowel sound that has a consistent quality throughout its duration. There is no change in the sound as it is spoken.
- A **diphthong** is a complex vowel sound that begins with one vowel sound and glides into another within the same syllable. This involves a movement or shift in the mouth position while the sound is being produced. Diphthongs are characterized by the shift in the quality of the vowel sound, making them more dynamic compared to the static nature of monophthongs.

Vowel sounds

Monophthongs	Diphthongs
/ɑ:/ - <u>c</u> art	/ɪə/ - <u>h</u> ere
/æ/ - <u>c</u> at	/eə/ - <u>th</u> ere
/e/ - <u>t</u> ell	/eɪ/ - <u>s</u> ay
/ə/ - <u>a</u> gain	/aɪ/ - <u>l</u> ike
/ʌ/ - <u>f</u> un	/aʊ/ - <u>n</u> ow
/ɜ:/ - <u>th</u> ird	/ɔɪ/ - <u>b</u> oy
/ɪ/ - <u>b</u> ig	/ʊə/ - <u>t</u> our
/i:/ - <u>s</u> leep	/əʊ/ - <u>ph</u> one
/u/ - <u>t</u> ook	
/u:/ - <u>p</u> ool	
/ɔ:/ - <u>f</u> our	
/p/ - <u>p</u> op	

	Monophthongs				Diphthongs		
	i:	ɪ	ʊ	u:	ɪə	eɪ	
Vowels	Sheep	ship	good	shoot	here	wait	
	e	ə	ɜ:	ɔ:	ʊə	ɔɪ	əʊ
	bed	teacher	bird	door	tourist	boy	show
Consonants	æ	ʌ	ɑ:	ɒ	eə	aɪ	əʊ
	cat	up	far	on	hair	my	cow
	p	b	t	d	tʃ	dʒ	k
Consonants	pea	boat	tea	dog	cheese	June	car
	f	v	θ	ð	s	z	ʃ
	fly	video	think	this	see	zoo	shall
Consonants	m	n	ŋ	h	l	r	W
	man	now	sing	hat	love	red	wet
							j
							yes

Phonemic chart : Voiced unvoiced

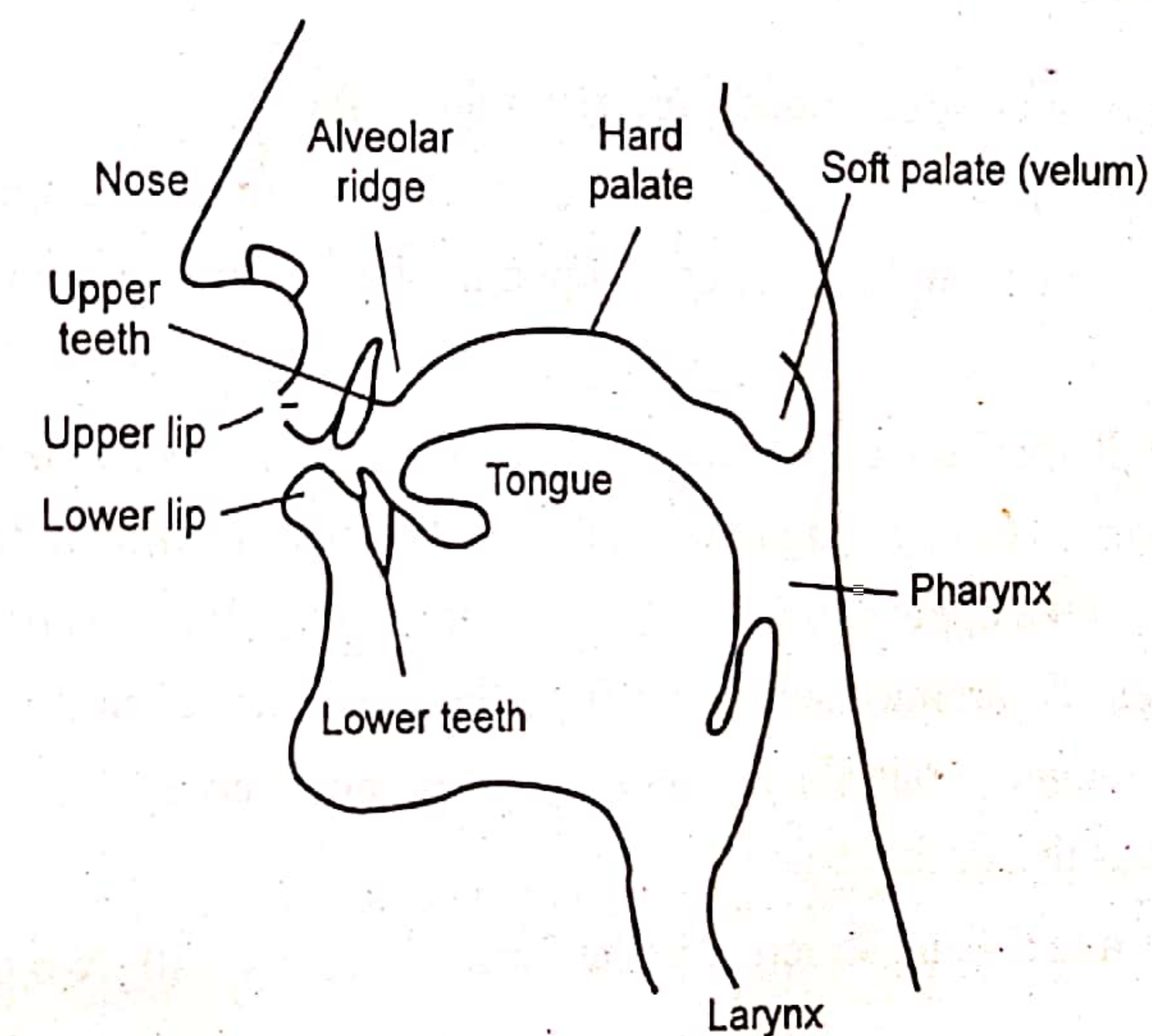
4.3 Places of Articulation

- Articulation is a common term used in speech pathology. Articulation is the formation of clear and distinct sounds in speech. The production of sounds involves the coordinated movement of your lips, tongue, teeth, palate, and your respiratory system governing the airstream, i.e. the movement of air as it is pushed up from the lungs during the process of speech production. To understand the places of articulation first of all let us understand the airstream mechanisms involved in producing sound and the organs of speech.

4.3.1 Airstream Mechanisms

- The airstream mechanism is the method by which airflow is created in the vocal tract. The airstream mechanism is mandatory for most sound production and constitutes the first part of this process, which is called **initiation**.
- The organ generating the airstream is called the **initiator** and there are three initiators used in human oral languages :
 - The diaphragm together with the ribs and lungs (*Pulmonic mechanisms*) - The airstream begins at the lungs which act as initiator in pushing air out (egressive) or in drawing air in (ingressive).
 - The glottis (*Glottalic mechanisms*)- The closed glottis works as the initiator and the air moves in or out of the pharynx, thus producing sounds.
 - The tongue (*Lingual or "velaric" mechanisms*)- The back of the tongue is used as the initiator and the air in the mouth is set in motion to produce certain click sounds using only the velaric ingressive airstream.

4.3.2 Organs of Speech



- The organs involved in the production of speech sounds are called **organs of speech**. The air that we breathe out comes out of the lungs. Before it reaches the outer atmosphere, various organs of our body convert it into speech sounds. These are the organs of speech. They can be divided into three groups :

1. The respiratory system - Lungs, muscles, trachea

- **Lungs** : The air that we breathe passes through the throat into the lungs through a tube called **trachea**. The muscles of the lungs expand and contract due to ingression and egression of air. The egressive airstream produces all speech sounds and the ingressive airstream produces non-linguistics sounds..

2. The phonatory system - Larynx, vocal cords

- It is the main organ referred to as the sound box. In the larynx, there are vocal cords. Normally, vocal cords are held wide apart and the air passes freely. When the vocal cords are held together, the air cannot pass freely and there is a vibration, which produces voiced sounds.
- When the vocal cords open for the air, this opening is called **glottis**. Different kinds of sounds are produced due to different states of the glottis like voiced, voiceless, murmur and creaky voice. When the vocal cords vibrate while producing speech sound, it is called voiced sound and the vocal cords do not vibrate while producing speech sound, it is called voiceless sound.

3. The articulatory system - Nose, mouth, tongue, teeth, lips

- **Pharynx** : This includes active and passive articulators. One opening goes to the mouth which is called **oral cavity** and the other opening goes to the nose which is called **nasal cavity**.
- **Oral cavity** : It includes upper jaw - Upper lip, upper teeth and palate, lower jaw - Lower lip, lower teeth and tongue and palate - It separates mouth from the nose. The hard ridge behind the upper front teeth is an alveolar ridge which is rough and is covered with little ridges. To produce sound, air from the lungs passes continuously through the mouth, but the tongue is raised sufficiently close to the alveolar ridge to cause friction as it partially blocks the air that passes.
- **Nasal cavity** : It is a blank structure in the form of a cavity with two openings at the end of the cavity.

4.3.3 Places of Articulation

The places of articulation are the ones where the constrictions and obstructions of air occur. Following are the various places of articulation :

1. **Bilabial** : Bilabial consonants occur when you block/constrict airflow out of the mouth by bringing your lips together.

English contains the following three bilabial consonants : The sound of p in 'purse', b in 'back' and m in 'mad'.

2. **Labio-dental (Lower lip and upper front teeth)** : Labio-dental consonants occur when you block/constrict airflow by curling your lower lip back and raising it to touch your upper row of teeth.

English contains the following two labio-dental sounds :

f as in "few" and "calf"

v as in "vine" and "have"

3. **Dental (Blade and upper front teeth)** : Dental consonants occur when you block/constrict airflow by placing your slimy tongue against your upper teeth. English contains the following two labio-dental sounds :

'th' as in "thick" and "bath"

'th' as in "the" and "rather"

4. Alveolar : (Blade and the alveolar ridge)

The alveolar ridge is where your teeth meet your gums.

You create alveolar consonants when you raise your tongue to the alveolar ridge to block or constrict airflow.

The English alveolar consonants are as follows :

n as in "no" and "man"

t as in "tab" and "rat"

d as in "dip" and "bad"

s as in "suit" and "bus"

z as in "zit" and "jazz"

l as in "luck" and "fully"

5. **Post - alveolar (Blade and back of the alveolar ridge)** : When you retract your tongue back just a bit from the alveolar ridge, the sounds change enough to be recognized as distinct consonants.

So post-alveolar consonants are those that occur when the tongue blocks or constricts airflow at the point just beyond the alveolar ridge.

The post-alveolar english consonants are as follows :

Sound of 'sh' as in "shot" or "brush"

Sound of 'sio' as in "vision" or 's' in "measure"

Sound of 'ch' as in "check" or "match"

Sound of 'j' as in "jam" or 'dʒ' as in "badge"

6. Palatal (front of tongue and hard palate) : The roof of your mouth is the hard palate. You create palatal consonants when you raise the tongue to this point and constrict airflow.

English has only one palatal consonant :

Sound of 'y' as in "yes"

7. Velar (Back of tongue and soft palate) : Behind your hard palate you have the velum or soft palate. Unlike the bony hard palate in front of it, this consists of soft, mucousy tissue. You make velar consonants when you raise the back of your tongue to the velum to block or restrict airflow.

English has the following velar consonants :

Sound of 'ŋ' as in "going" and 'un' in "uncle"

Sound of 'k' as in "kite" and 'ck' in "back"

Sound of 'g' as in "good" and "bug"

Sound of 'w' as in "wet" and

8. Glottal (Open or partially closed glottis) : The glottis is actually two vocal folds (i.e. vocal cords). It acts as a sort of bottle cap to your windpipe. The sound is produced by the air coming through a partially closed glottis.

English has the following glottal consonants :

Sound of 'h' in 'hi'

4.3.4 Phonetic Transcription

- Phonetic transcription is the visual representation of the sounds of speech using symbols. It allows linguists, language learners, and speech professionals to accurately capture how words are pronounced, regardless of how they are spelled in the standard writing system. Phonetic transcription represents the specific sounds (Phonemes - A set of smallest units of speech) used in speech, offering a more precise way to study pronunciation. The phoneme is represented between slashes as shown in the IPA. For example, sound of letter **b** in **bat** is represented as /b/.
- The phonetic transcription of a word uses international phonetic alphabets given above and gives their combination to represent the exact sound or pronunciation of an English word. Thus, a phonetic transcription represents the sound of a word. For example, the word "cat" is transcribed as /kæt/ combining individual symbols of sounds from the IPA.

Phonetic transcription demonstrating vowel sounds :

Word	Vowel Sound (IPA Symbol)	IPA Transcription
cat	/æ/	/kæt/
bed	/ɛ/	/bɛd/
sit	/ɪ/	/sɪt/
go	/ou/	/gou/
cup	/ʌ/	/kʌp/
father	/ɑ:/	/ˈfɑ:ðər/
see	/i:/	/si:/
book	/ʊ/	/bʊk/
rain	/eɪ/	/reɪn/
my	/aɪ/	/maɪ/
boat	/ou/	/bout/
now	/aʊ/	/naʊ/
air	/ɛə/	/ɛə/
clear	/ɪə/	/klaɪə/
phone	/ou/	/foun/
hand	/æ/	/hænd/
moon	/u:/	/mu:n/
star	/ɑ:/	/stɑ:r/
butter	/ʌ/	/ˈbʌtər/

Phonetic transcription demonstrating consonant sounds :

Word	Consonant Sound (IPA Symbol)	IPA Transcription
cat	/k/	/kæt/
dog	/d/	/dɒg/
zebra	/z/	/zebrə/
shoe	/ʃ/	/ʃu:/
game	/g/	/geɪm/
chicken	/tʃ/	/ˈtʃɪkən/
ball	/b/	/bɔ:l/

man	/m/	/mæn/
fast	/f/	/fæst/
hat	/h/	/hæt/
van	/v/	/væn/
ring	/r/	/rɪŋ/
whale	/w/	/weɪl/
yellow	/j/	/jɛləʊ/
sing	/ŋ/	/sɪŋ/
think	/θ/	/θɪŋk/
this	/ð/	/ðɪs/
jump	/dʒ/	/dʒʌmp/
cousin	/k/	/kʌzən/

Quick bites :

- ✓ For speaking, clear pronunciation of words is crucial to avoid misunderstanding and confusion.
- ✓ English words have spellings which do not tell about their sound.
- ✓ English language has words like homophones where spellings and meaning are different but pronunciation is same.
- ✓ The English alphabets are lesser than the sounds used in words.
- ✓ The International phonetic alphabets are symbols that denote all the sounds made through mouth.
- ✓ The knowledge of IPA and phonetic transcription helps in reading a dictionary and identify the correct pronunciation of a word

4.4 Presentation Skills

- In your student and professional life, you may have to give presentations at many occasions. Presentation skills are important to effectively convey ideas, information and messages to the audience. A well-executed presentation can engage, inform, and persuade listeners, ensuring that key points are understood and remembered. Strong presentation skills such as clear communication, confident body language, and effective use of visual aids - Help to maintain audience attention. Whether in business, education, or other fields, mastering these skills can enhance your credibility, boost your confidence, and increase

your chances of success in achieving desired outcomes. Effective presentations can also inspire action and foster collaboration, making them essential for professional growth and impactful communication.

- The purpose of your presentation may be different at different times. These purposes are as follows :
 - To give information.
 - To explain a concept in detail.
 - To present a plan of a project to delegate work to members of the team.
 - To analyse a problem and sometimes also give recommendations to solve such problems.
 - To create an awareness.
 - To present the progress of your work.
 - To present in front of your professors for academic purpose.
 - To persuade the audience to agree with your ideas, usually any business proposal or marketing presentation.

Preparation

As seen above, there are different purposes of presentations. In order to fulfil these purposes or in other words, in order to make our presentation effective, a thorough preparation is required. In order to make a good presentation, let's divide it into three phases : 1) Planning 2) Preparing and 3) Presenting.

4.4.1 Planning

- This is a very important phase with three steps namely defining purpose, analysing audience and analysing venue (Place of presentation).

1) Defining purpose : It means, clarifying in your mind, the purpose of your presentation. You must think and analyse, what you want to achieve through the presentation and what all needs to be done for that. Whether you want to create an awareness or persuade an audience, you have to include such illustrations and proofs in your content which backs your thoughts on the topic. Being clear about your purpose is important as it helps in deciding what to present and how to present.

2) Analysing audience and locale : You must try to find out who is your audience. If you are going to deliver presentation in your college or organization then you may know everyone, but if you are invited outside your organization, then you must inquire with the organizer about the audience. Once you know the audience, you can note down

points which are relevant to your audience so that while preparing the content you may include such points and examples.

- Also, you must be aware of the place where you have to make the presentation as it helps in deciding how you are going to present. If you have to present outside your organization, then it is advisable to visit the place and check for various things like, whether a projector is available or a black/white board, whether a podium will be given or not, how big is the room, whether there is a space for moving around in the room or stage is there or not, etc. Visiting the place gives you an idea how you have to prepare for presentation and it also helps you in lessening your nervousness due to the fear of unknown.

4.4.2 Preparing for Presentation

- This mainly consists of content preparation. Based on your purpose and audience, now you know what should be included in your presentation. You may gather the information from your books, journals, your knowledge and experience about the topic and take help from other experts in the field. While gathering, it is important that you remove data which is not relevant to your purpose otherwise you will end up taking a huge amount data. Also, the time factor must be kept in mind while choosing the content.
- Once you have decided what all needs to be said in the presentation, you must arrange it in order to bring coherence in your presentation. The content can broadly be divided into three portions namely *introduction, main body and conclusion*.
 - 1) An introduction must be such that the audience becomes curious to listen further. You can use a catchy sentence, a quote or a story which can be related to the topic. The introduction consists of introduction of yourself and the topic. In the introduction part, you must clarify your purpose and give a brief idea about what you are going to speak, i.e. the agenda of your presentation.
 - 2) The main body is the entire content and it can be organized using different ways as explained in the section 1.4.4- "deciding the pattern for your speech". While preparing the content of presentation, remember the five Cs - Clarity, conciseness, completeness, continuity and consistency explained in section 1.4.3.
 - 3) The last part of the presentation - The conclusion is very important because it is the time when the speaker leaves an impact in the minds of the audience. Many people complete the conclusion in a hurry, but it is advisable to give considerable time to conclusion. Summarize the whole presentation and remind the audience of your purpose by again mentioning the same story or quote you said in the introduction. This helps the audience retain the information and has a lasting effect in their minds.

Organizing a presentation

- If you have been asked to deliver a speech on a given subject, the first thing that you do is to decide what to speak. The content mainly depends on the purpose of the speech and the audience. So before preparing the speech, it is important to clarify yourself with your purpose and understand your audience so that you can cite illustrations that are more relevant to your purpose and audience.
- Whether one gives a well-prepared speech or an extempore, the important thing is the flow of the speech. Any communication must have connectivity and continuity in the flow of ideas to make it more interesting and comprehensible. Following are the patterns one can use to arrange the content of public speaking as well as presentations:

1. **Chronological method** : All topics that are described with respect to time can be arranged in a chronology. Presentation of ideas in the sequence of their occurrence makes it clear and easy to remember. Topics dealing with history of anything - A country or a sport, biographies, planning of a project dealing one day after the other and instructional guides explaining any process step by step are all examples of chronological order.
2. **Categorical method** : When there is a detailed explanation of a topic, it can be broken into categories to make it easier for the speaker to remember and the listener to understand. All topics that are meant to give information or knowledge can be divided into subtopics. Mostly the theories in your textbooks use the categorical pattern.
3. **Causal method** : In this method the content is mainly divided into the reason of a problem and its results or the causes and its effects. Sometimes, it is also followed by the solutions. Usually, first the reasons and then results are presented but sometimes the reverse order may be used in order to create greater impact. This can be done by citing examples of effects of a problem which relates to the audience creating more involvement and making it emotive. Topics like "global warming", 'corruption', 'effects of social media', 'increasing number of nuclear families', etc. can be arranged in this manner.
4. **Spatial method** : There are topics where the reference can be a place. While describing different cultures, you may refer to different places, like "in the city it is....while in villages people prefer to ..." or "moving towards the east side of the city.....while in the west...". Also, if you are describing a structure - of a building or a machine, you may move with respect to space - from inside to outside, top to bottom or left to right. Topics like "Adalaj ni vaav - the masterpiece of a well", "design of a lathe machine", "A guide to north india tourist places", etc. can be arranged using spatial methods.

4.4.3 Presenting

This includes the effective use of visual aids, delivery of speech and non-verbal communication.

1) Effective use of visual aids :

The presentation differs from a speech because in it, you also show or display what you speak. Showing along with speaking creates more impact in the mind of the audience. Anything which we see, we tend to grasp and remember easier. There are various ways of showing your content to the audience like writing on a board, showing charts and through power points. To make the effective use of all these, you must take care of following points :

- Check for all your requirements, whether projector is available or not, laptop or computer is available or you have to carry your own device, availability of internet connection if required, uninterrupted power supply.
- If you have to use a board, check for chalks or marker pens. Also check whether marker pens are in working condition because if they are not, you will waste your time right in the beginning and that will create more nervousness in you. This may lead to a situation where you may forget certain points, hence such small carelessness may become a spoiler for the presentation.
- Keep the visual aid visible to the audience by taking care that you or any pillar or anything is not blocking it.
- Your handwriting must be legible and big enough to make it visible till the end.
- Font used in a power point must be simple and big enough so that everyone can read. Avoid using fonts with curves and italics.
- Do not use too many colours in any visual aid. If you want to differentiate by colour, it is advisable to use only two colours.
- Do not change the slide (In case of ppt), chart (In case of flipcharts) or erase from the board, unless everyone has read the content. Give enough time to the audience to go through the visual aid.
- Write only points, and not the entire content in the visual aid. Also, do not crowd visual aid with many points.
- While speaking, avoid directly reading from the visual aid. Remember, that you are using visual aid to make it easier for the audience, and not for you to remember your content.

- Use your hand or a pointer to point the visual aid, whenever you want the audience to have a look at it.
- Use of diagrams, graphs, photographs, figures or plans must be included as far as possible as it makes it more interesting. But take care that only one diagram must be there on one slide/ chart.
- While writing on a board, make optimum use of the board by making parts. Also, keep the portion on one side of the board if you have to refer it later.

2) Delivery of speech :

There are different ways that people use to deliver the speech. Different people may choose a different way to deliver a speech as per their preference and convenience, but each have their own advantages and disadvantages. You must choose the delivery of speech appropriate for a public speech, elocution and presentation keeping in mind, the advantages and disadvantages so as to make it more effective.

1. **Memorization :** Write down your speech and read it several times to memorize it and then speak in front of the audience from your memory. In this type of delivery of speech, you don't keep a paper with you containing your speech or brief notes.

Advantages :

- As you have memorized, you will not leave out any point.
- There is a very high scope of eye contact and gestures.
- If you have memorized it well, you also look very natural.

Disadvantages :

- When you speak something from your memory, there is a high risk of forgetting a point suddenly, and you will have to try very hard to remember it or sometimes skip the point and go to the next one.
- Some people, who are not very good in memorizing, may fumble a lot and it will take away the natural effect.
- You may fumble a lot in between.
- There is no flexibility. Eg. If a person from audience asks a question in between, you may forget where you left and it becomes difficult to continue fluently.

2. **Manuscript :** Write your complete speech and carry it with you to read out word to word from the script.

Advantages :

- As you are going to read out everything, you will not miss out any point.

- This method is appropriate for people who are very good readers and can add paralinguistics while reading.
- The speech will be perfect and there won't be any fumbling.
- Flexibility is there, as you can always start from the point where you left, even if you are interrupted.
- While using this method, you are more confident as you don't have any fear of forgetting.

Disadvantages :

- If you are not a good reader, the entire speech will be very monotonous and unnatural.
- It sometimes becomes very boring for the audience when a person just reads out from a paper.
- The audience may not trust what you are saying as it may not look like your original thoughts.
- The scope of eye contact and gestures is minimum.

3. Impromptu : Sometimes you may have to deliver a speech without any preparation. For example, when you are asked to give a speech on the farewell of your colleague, you have to speak on the spot. This is called **impromptu**.

Advantages :

- It is highly natural and original as you are speaking what you think.
- Scope of eye contact and gestures is maximum.
- There's a lot of flexibility as it can be as interactive as possible.
- More paralinguistics can be used.

Disadvantages :

- Biggest disadvantage is that if your knowledge about the topic is not sufficient, you will fumble.
- Sometimes, you may have to give long pauses to think what to speak which may leave the audience irritated.
- There is no editing time and so, the arrangement of ideas may be haphazard losing out continuity in thoughts.

4. Notes : Taking notes with you while delivering a speech is the most popular method. This method uses the advantages of memorization and manuscript method. It also allows the impromptu thoughts to be included. In this method, you take a note along, which has

only main points to be covered written in sequence. You first prepare the whole speech several times. While delivering the speech, you speak without seeing the notes, but if required you just make a glance into the notes to check the sequence or the points you are supposed to speak on a particular point.

Advantages :

- There are no chances of forgetting any point as you have the notes written in a sequence.
- It gives more flexibility and can be interactive.
- Scope of eye contact and gestures is more.
- It looks natural and interesting.
- There are no disadvantages of this method if you are well prepared. But if you haven't done enough preparation, then any method will fail in making your speech effective.

3) Importance of non-verbal communication :

A well written and well prepared speech accompanied with proper eye contact, gestures and paralinguistics acts like an icing on the cake. Making an eye contact with the audience helps in gaining their trust and connects them with the topic. Using appropriate gestures helps you to explain your point better and creates interest. Dressing up appropriately and maintaining correct posture helps create good impression on the minds of the audience. Along with this, a very important non-verbal aspect is the time factor. You must be aware about how much time to use for which topic and when to end. Stretching too much creates boredom and not discussing in detail when required, leaves the audience confused. Hence, you must time your speech and complete each topics as well as entire speech on time.

Quick Bites :

- ✓ For an effective presentation, first you must be clear about the purpose of your presentation.
- ✓ Keep the audience in mind while preparing for a presentation.
- ✓ A well - arranged content provides ease in understanding.
- ✓ A connectivity of thoughts helps the listeners to comprehend well.
- ✓ All types of public speaking like presentations require content which must be prepared in advance.
- ✓ In order that there are connectivity of thoughts, presentation can be broadly arranged into three parts namely introduction, main body and conclusion.

- ✓ There are four methods of arranging the content, namely - chronological, categorical, causal and spatial depending on the type of content.
- ✓ Chronological method means arranging in sequence of occurrence of events, categorical method means categorizing in various types, causal method means to present the causes and effects of an issue and spatial method uses place or space as a reference.
- ✓ Start with a smile and use something catchy to create anticipation in the minds of the audience.
- ✓ Do not conclude in a haste, and leave a point for the audience to ponder.
- ✓ Use body language to enhance the effectiveness of your presentation like dressing appropriately, making eye contact with everyone, using hand gestures and facial expressions and having a correct posture.
- ✓ Use of paralinguistics is very important for effective presentation. Make maximum use of space available by moving around on the stage or the room.
- ✓ There are four methods of delivery of speech - Memorization, manuscript, impromptu and notes.
- ✓ Memorization method provides scope of body language but there is a risk of forgetting.
- ✓ Manuscript method has very less scope of body language but can be perfect because you have written the whole speech verbatim.
- ✓ Impromptu method is highly natural with maximum scope of body language, but chances of fumbling are there if there is lack of knowledge about the topic.
- ✓ Keeping the notes with you and delivering without seeing, is the best method of delivery of speech, which has all advantages of the above methods and counters their disadvantages.
- ✓ While presenting it is important to use visuals to create more impact on audience.
- ✓ A wise use of visual aids is required to make the presentation effective.
- ✓ Non-verbal communication like eye contact, facial expressions, gestures, postures and physical appearance are crucial for effective presentation.

4.5 Introduction to Group Communication

- Group communication refers to the process of sharing and exchanging information and ideas and collecting feedback on any project or work done by the group with common goal. It is used for decision making on important matters, to solve problems or discuss issues related to particular topic in relation to the group or for benefit of a larger audience. It

- happens in formal settings like meetings, conferences, teams, etc.
- Group communication also involves formal and informal conversations or group discussions among a group of people. It includes debates between two parties.

4.5.1 Conversations

- Conversation is a casual, informal exchange of thoughts, feelings, or information between two or more people. It can happen spontaneously and covers a wide range of topics. Conversations are often relaxed, and participants may switch topics, share personal experiences, or simply engage in small talk. The primary goal of a conversation is often to build rapport and maintain a social connection. Conversations are usually not planned.
- Normal daily conversations are simple and easy to handle, but conversations in professional life may have many implications. Though conversations are more casual, but they affect your professional life in many ways, particularly when the conversation takes a turn into something crucial or controversial. Moreover, conflicting situations arising with others may require to have a difficult conversation with them to address the matter and resolve differences.
- During difficult or unpleasant conversations, one must take care of the following points :
- Some recommended skills to deal with this are :
 1. **Information gathering** : Make sure you have your facts straight before you begin, know what you are going to say and why you are going to say it. Try to anticipate any questions or concerns others may have and think carefully about how you will answer questions.
 2. **Being assertive** : Once you are sure that something needs to be communicated then do so in a self-assured way. Do not find yourself backing down or changing your mind mid conversation.
 3. **Being empathetic** : Put yourself in the other person's shoes and think about how they will feel about what you are telling them, give others time to ask questions and make comments.
 4. **Stay calm and focused** : Communication becomes easier when we are calm, take some deep breaths and try to maintain an air of calmness, others are more likely to remain calm if you do. Start conversation with something you both agree, because this sets up a common ground to communicate further. It also makes the other person comfortable to share his/her thoughts freely.
 5. **Listen attentively** : Be involved in listening through non-verbal cues so that the other person feels heard and is encouraged to share thoughts openly without hesitation. Never be in a hurry to reply back without letting the other person speak completely.

4.5.2 Dialogues

- Dialogues are sometimes interchangeably used with conversations, but there is a subtle difference between the two. Dialogues are more purposeful and structured form of communication. They are planned to have more focussed exchange of ideas, used to understand different perspectives, solve problems and reach a consensus. Dialogues are often used in formal settings as debates, philosophical discussions or literature and also in personal life to exchange meaningful conversations.

Following are the key points to keep in mind while doing a dialogue :

- 1. Clarity :** You should be clear in your communication in terms of thoughts and language.
- 2. Active listening :** Pay full attention to the speaker, avoid interrupting and demonstrate understanding through verbal and non-verbal cues.
- 3. Empathy :** See the other person's perspective and respond sensitively
- 4. Open ended questions :** Encourage deeper conversations by asking questions that are open ended so that the speaker shares more.
- 5. Respectful tone :** Have a respectful tone even when disagreeing.
- 6. Feedback :** Give feedback about your opinion so that more points can be discussed through combined perspectives.

4.5.3 Debates

A debate is a formal, structured argument between two or more individuals or teams present opposing viewpoints on specific topic. The goal of the debate is to persuade the audience and judges of the validity of one's points through logic, evidence and reasoning. Each team is allowed equal opportunity to present their viewpoints. Debates are organized around a clear issue or question, with one side arguing in favour and the other opposing it. Debates are mainly used in academic, political settings or media discussions.

For a successful and effective debate, following points should be taken into consideration :

- 1) Clear structure :** The debate should be well structured and the participants must be aware of it. Debate must start with an opening statement followed by arguments from both sides and must end with a closing or concluding statement.
- 2) Research and evidence :** The participants must prepare the topic by doing thorough research on the topic and must prepare arguments based on credible evidences. The strength of evidences helps in making the arguments more persuasive.

- 3) Active listening :** All participants must actively listen to the opposing team so that they can understand their argument, identify weakness and present their counter argument in a thoughtful way. Active listening helps in anticipating challenges and preparing strong counterarguments.
- 4) Clear and concise :** The participants must present their point clearly and concisely with simple language. Complex thoughts confuse people and make your point weak.
- 5) Factual and logical reasoning :** Arguments must be based on facts and not imagination or fiction. They should be backed by logical reasoning. Facts can be presented in terms of evidence or statistics which makes the arguments stronger and persuasive.
- 6) Respect and professionalism :** Even though debates involves opposing arguments and involves proving the other party wrong, the participants must take care to be respectful and professional avoiding any offending remarks or personal attacks and insults.

4.5.4 Group Discussions

A group discussion is a structured conversation where a group of people come together to exchange ideas, share perspectives, and explore various viewpoints on a specific topic or issue. It typically involves active participation from all members, where each person contributes their thoughts, arguments, or solutions while listening to other's inputs. Group discussions can be formal or informal, and they are commonly used in academic settings, interviews, decision-making processes, or team meetings. The purpose of a group discussion is to generate ideas, stimulate critical thinking, and collaborate to reach a deeper understanding or consensus on the topic at hand. Effective group discussions encourage communication skills, teamwork, and problem-solving, as well as help participants learn how to manage differing opinions respectfully.

Important qualities evaluated by employers during a group discussion for recruitment purposes / qualities important to participate in group discussions in your professional life.

- 1) Knowledge of the topic :** You will be able to speak with conviction in a group discussion, only if you have in-depth knowledge about the topic. You should be able to grasp and analyse the situation at a deeper level. You must have your original viewpoints and suggestions. To be able to participate in group discussions successfully, it is always advisable to keep yourself updated about your surroundings. This will help you speak something about the topic and the rest you can gauge from what others say. Taking initiative, problem solving and creativity, etc. are required in professional life

and that can be shown in the group discussion. But, this will only be possible if you have a proper knowledge and understanding of the topic.

2) **Communication skills** : During a group discussion the following skills are evaluated :

- 1) **Verbal communication skills** : You are expected to use right words with correct sentence construction. If you are able to use error free language, then it becomes easy for other members of the group to understand your point.
- 2) **Non-verbal communication skills** : You must use correct body language throughout the discussion, like straight posture, correct gestures, making eye contact with all members, nodding your head while listening and using appropriate facial expressions. This helps you to gain positive response from others.
- 3) **Listening skills** : You cannot continue the discussion without listening to others. It is important to either take forward the point of the previous speaker if you agree or put your point mentioning how and why you differ from the previous speaker. This is how you have to create a thread of thoughts and weave them to come to a conclusion. You cannot put your independent thought, without considering what has already been said.

4) **Clarity of thought** : How clear you are about your thought can be shown using intonation, articulation and voice modulation.

3) **Group behaviour** : How one reacts in a group is shown by the ability to interact with other members. While doing so, emotional maturity is required. You must be able to remain objective, empathetic and mature. You must neither dominate the group nor get dominated by others. You must respect each and every member's views and try to cooperate and coordinate with everyone smoothly. Also, being able to listen to all equally is also a desirable group behaviour.

4) **Leadership potential** : Any group cannot carry on its task without a leader. A leader is one who leads everyone towards the goal. The employers look for leadership qualities in you during the group discussion because despite of no appointed leader, the candidates who have these qualities will emerge as leaders. Where can you show your leadership qualities ? A leader is an initiator, has knowledge, emotional stability, objectivity, communication skill, control, is a motivator and a decision maker. By starting or ending the discussion you can show you are initiator or decision maker. When you are able to calm down hostility among members, you are able to show control, emotional ability and objectivity. You can even show the objectivity by not getting carried away by any opposition in the group and rather consider everyone's views. By encouraging silent members to speak up, you can show that you are a motivator. Thus you can get

opportunities to show your leadership qualities at different points of time in the group discussion.

4.6 Communication Style in Conversations / Group Communication

4.6.1 Assertive Communication

- **Assertive communication** is a communication style where individuals express their opinions, feelings, and needs clearly and confidently, while respecting the rights of others. People who communicate assertively value themselves and their well-being, including their emotional, physical, and spiritual needs, and advocate for their rights in a firm yet respectful manner. Assertive communication involves :

- Clearly and respectfully stating needs and desires
- Expressing feelings in an appropriate and respectful way
- Listening attentively without interrupting others
- Maintaining control over oneself
- Making good eye contact and adopting a relaxed body posture
- Speaking in a calm, clear tone
- Building a sense of connection with others
- Not allowing others to manipulate or mistreat them
- Standing up for their rights.

- **The benefits of assertive communication include :**

- Feeling more connected to others
- Gaining a sense of control over one's life
- Developing maturity by addressing issues as they arise
- Creating a respectful environment that fosters growth for everyone involved.

4.6.2 Aggressive Communication

- **Aggressive communication** is a style where individuals express their feelings, opinions, and needs in a way that disregards or violates the rights of others. Those who communicate aggressively tend to be verbally or physically abusive, aiming to dominate or control others.

- **Common behaviors of aggressive communicators include :**

- Trying to dominate or control others
- Using humiliation or intimidation to assert power
- Criticizing, blaming, or attacking others
- Acting impulsively

- Having a low tolerance for frustration
- Speaking in a loud, demanding, or overbearing tone
- Failing to listen effectively
- Frequently interrupting others
- Instilling fear or resentment in others.
- **The consequences of aggressive communication include :**
 - Becoming isolated from others
 - Alienating those around them
 - Creating an atmosphere of fear and hostility
 - Failing to take responsibility for their own issues, which prevents personal growth and maturity.

4.6.3 Passive Communication

- **Passive communication** is a style where individuals consistently avoid expressing their opinions, feelings, or needs, and fail to assert their rights. As a result, passive communicators often don't address situations that cause frustration or anger, allowing grievances to build up without acknowledging them. Once they reach a breaking point, they may explode unexpectedly. Common traits of passive communication include :
 - Failing to assert themselves
 - Allowing others to infringe upon their rights, either intentionally or unintentionally
 - Not expressing their feelings, needs, or opinions
 - Speaking softly or apologetically
 - Exhibiting poor eye contact and slumped posture.
- **The impact of a passive communication pattern is that individuals may :**
 - Feel anxious, as life seems out of their control
 - Experience feelings of depression due to a sense of being stuck or hopeless
 - Develop resentment as their needs remain unmet
 - Feel confused by ignoring their own emotions
 - Struggle to mature, as unresolved issues and unacceptable behaviors are never addressed. This often leads to occasional explosive outbursts that are disproportionate to the triggering situation. Afterward, these individuals may feel shame, guilt, or confusion, only to revert back to passivity.

4.6.4 Passive-aggressive Communication

- **Passive-aggressive communication** is a style where individuals appear passive on the surface but express their anger in subtle, indirect, or behind-the-scenes ways. People who develop this pattern often feel powerless, trapped, and resentful, finding it difficult to directly confront those with whom they are angry. Instead, they express their frustration by subtly undermining the source of their resentment. Passive - aggressive communicators may :
 - Mutter to themselves instead of addressing the issue directly
 - Struggle to acknowledge their anger
 - Use facial expressions that do not align with their true feelings
 - Rely on sarcasm
 - Deny there's any problem
 - Appear cooperative while intentionally creating disruptions or annoyances
 - Engage in subtle sabotage to "get even".
- **The consequences of passive-aggressive communication include :**
 - Becoming alienated from others
 - Remaining stuck in feelings of powerlessness
 - Expressing resentment without addressing the real issues, which prevents personal growth and maturity.

4.6.5 Persuasive Communication

- **Persuasive communication** is essential for success in the business world. Whether you are motivating employees to align with company goals or persuading colleagues or clients to consider your ideas, effective persuasion helps you gain support, unify teams, and encourage collaboration. Mastering the art of persuasive communication can significantly enhance your influence and drive collective success.
- To become a persuasive communicator, you should :
 1. Understand your audience
 2. Connect with the attention
 3. Establish your credibility
 4. Adapt your message to suit the communication medium
 5. Highlight the benefits of your ideas or proposals
 6. Use positive and confident body language.

Quick Bites :

- ✓ To be able to do conversations and dialogues effectively in organizations and personal life.
- ✓ To be able to showcase professionalism and use effective arguments in debates.
- ✓ To be able to give valuable inputs in a group discussion and create a good impression, have a good knowledge about things around you or gather it from what the others speak.
- ✓ To understand various communication styles like assertive, aggressive, passive, passive aggressive and persuasive.
- ✓ To be able to practice assertive and persuasive style of communication with different people in the organization according to requirement and goal.
- ✓ Communicate using small and error-free sentences.
- ✓ Make eye contact with everyone in the group, use positive gestures, keep your posture straight and have a pleasant facial expression.
- ✓ Talk with a smile and never try to offend any member of the group, even if you disagree with them.
- ✓ Listen attentively to all.
- ✓ Do not jump to your own point and ignore the previous person's point.
- ✓ Let the previous person finish speaking before you start your own point.
- ✓ Encourage others to speak by asking open-ended questions.
- ✓ Try to keep solving any dispute between other members and bring the group back on track.
- ✓ Bring the discussion to end when the time is over, by summarizing and concluding.

Practical Exercise

1. Do a role play with groups of 2-3 students doing conversations on various topics where they can demonstrate the different styles of communication.
2. Make a group of 8-10 students and take a topic of your choice. Sit in a circle and do a group discussion for 20 mins on this topic. Ask the other students who are not participating, to observe and make notes. At the end, share the observations and analyse the performance of each participant.

Suggested group discussion topics :

- a. Impact of social media on human relationships.
 - b. Is online education as effective as traditional education ?
 - c. The role of artificial intelligence in the future job market.
 - d. Sustainable development vs. economic growth.
 - e. Mental health awareness in schools and workplaces.
3. Make two groups and decide a topic where each group will either agree or disagree with the topic. Understand the nuances of debate through this exercise.

Suggested debate topics :

- a. Should homework be banned in schools ?
- b. Is the death penalty justifiable ?
- c. Does technology make us more isolated or more connected ?
- d. Is a college degree still worth the investment ?
- e. Is globalization beneficial or harmful to developing countries ?

4.7 University Questions with Answers

1. Explain the evaluation components of group discussion as a selection process.
(Refer section 4.5.4) **GTU : Winter-17, Marks 7**
2. What is a presentation ? Explain different purposes for making presentation.
(Refer section 4.4) **GTU : Summer-09, Marks 4**
3. What are the purposes of presentation ? Why should the presenter know his/her 'audience' before delivering presentation. (Refer sections 4.4 and 4.4.1)
GTU : Summer-15, Marks 4
4. Write guidelines to make effective use of visual aids.
(Refer section 4.4.3) **GTU : Summer-13, Marks 3**
5. Planning, preparing and presenting, all are equally important steps for an effective presentation. Justify the statement with supporting arguments.
(Refer sections 4.4.1 4.4.2 and 4.4.3) **GTU : Winter-17, Marks 7**
GTU : Summer-14, Marks 3
6. Give tips for success in group discussion. (Refer section 4.5.4)
7. What is group discussion as part of the recruitment process ? Which key skills are essential for successful participation in group discussion ? (Refer section 4.5.4) **GTU : Winter-19, Marks 4**
8. How will you use your body language as a tool to be successful in a group discussion ?
(Refer sections 4.5.4 and 1.3.1) **Marks 4**
9. Explain the organization of content for presentation. (Refer section 4.4.2) **Marks 4**

10. Match the phonetic transcriptions with the words. (Refer sections 4.2 and 4.2.1)

Mark 1

1.	/æpəl/	a.	energy
2.	/beɪsɪk/	b.	doctor
3.	/kæt/	c.	intuitive
4.	/dɒktə/	d.	history
5.	/enərdʒi/	e.	job
6.	/faɪnəl/	f.	apple
7.	/gləʊbəl/	g.	basic
8.	/hɪstəri/	h.	final
9.	/ɪntuːtɪv/	i.	global
10.	/dʒɒb/	j.	cat

11. Complete the transcriptions with one of the following diphthongs.

/eɪ/, /ʊə/, /eə/, /ɔɪ/, /əʊ/, /aʊ/, /oʊ/, /aɪ/, /əʊ/

1. /m__k/ (make)
2. /ʃ__/ (sure)
3. /b__r/ (bear)
4. /mpl__/ (employ)
5. /h__r/ (hear)
6. /t__n/ (town)
7. /h__m/ (home)
8. /s__t/ (sight)
9. /n__/ (know) (Refer sections 4.2 and 4.2.1)

Mark 1

12. Identify the correct words for the following phonetic transcriptions. Write the corresponding word for each transcription :

1. /æpl/
2. /beɪkər/
3. /ɪfɪld/
4. /flaʊər/
5. /græmə/
6. /dɒktə/
7. /ɪntrɪst/
8. /nɛfən/
9. /sʌmz/
10. /pleɪzər/ (Refer sections 4.2 and 4.2.1)

Mark 1

13. Circle the word that is pronounced differently from the other three words.

Mark 1

Accident	Access	accommodate	Accept
Sheep	Beer	Field	People
Angry	Jungle	English	Spring
Shout	Now	Round	Mould
Cheese	Chip	Machine	Attach
Sign	Foreign	Tongue	Campaign
Suit	Fruit	Cruise	Biscuit
Though	Rough	Enough	Tough
floor	poor	flood	Door
author	caught	laughter	daughter

(Refer sections 4.2 and 4.2.1)

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Notes

Unit 5

5

Listening and Reading Skills

Syllabus

Meaning, importance and purpose of listening, Listening Vs. Hearing, Types of listening, Barriers to effective listening, Traits of a good listener, Introduction, Meaning and Purpose of reading, Tips for improving reading skills, Techniques for effective reading : Skimming, Scanning, Structure of, text, Punctuation, Author's & Reader's point of view, Reading Comprehension.

Contents

- 5.1 Listening
- 5.2 Introduction, Meaning and Purpose of Reading
- 5.3 Tips for Improving Reading Skills
- 5.4 Techniques for Effective Reading
- 5.5 Reading Comprehension